However, the initial misunderstandings soon gave way to newer bonds between the two. Relations improved greatly with Russian President Boris Yeltsin's visit to India in January 1993. During this visit not only was the rupee-rouble exchange rate resolved but also the 1971 Indo-Russian Treaty of Peace, Friendship and Cooperation was substituted by a new 14-clause Treaty of Friendship and Cooperation valid for 20 years. This Treaty stipulated that the two countries would refrain from taking any action that might affect the security interests of the other, pledging support to each other's territorial integrity and non-interference in internal affairs.

The visit of Prime Minister Narasimha Rao to Moscow in June 1994 saw further improvement of relations. Russia also refrained from supply of arms to Pakistan. Primakov, first as Russian Foreign Minister, 1996 and then as Prime Minister in 1998 made all effort to boost the bilateral relations. During the visit of Indian Prime Minister H.D. Deve Gowda to Moscow in March 1997, Russia agreed to help India set up a nuclear power plant at Kudankulam. The United Front Government first under Deve Gowda and then under I.K. Gujaral did not introduce any significant change in India's foreign policy posture.

During Vajpayee's Prime Ministership, a breakthrough came in the year 2000. In the same year relations took a new turn with Putin assuming the office of the President of Russia. Putin visited New Delhi in 2000. The Declaration on strategic partnership was signed in 2000. This was not directed against any State/groups of states, and did not aim at creating military-political alliances. This declaration also set up the framework for convening Annual Summit Level Meetings, closer cooperation at international and regional forums, deepening and diversifying cooperation in sectors such as metallurgy, fuel and energy, information technology, communications and transport, consolidating defence and military cooperation, cooperation in the peaceful use of nuclear energy and outer space, cooperating in combating international terrorism and organized crimes among others. The idea of North-South Corridor was also floated in September 2000.‡

Again during the Vajpayee Government's tenure, the relations got a boost with another visit form Putin to New Delhi in 2002. The *Delhi*